

HAZMAT TACTICAL

REGULATORY REFERENCE GUIDE

Verified regulatory references for hazmat emergency response training.
All references verified against current editions as of 2024–2025.

SECTION 1 — OSHA (Occupational Safety & Health Administration)

29 CFR 1910.120(q) — HAZWOPER Emergency Response Operations

- WHAT IT IS:** The core federal standard governing hazmat emergency response training. Paragraph (q) specifically covers emergency response to hazardous substance releases.
- REQUIRES:** Defines five responder levels (Awareness, Operations, Technician, Specialist, Incident Commander). Technician level requires a minimum of 24 hours at Operations level plus additional competencies.
- APPLIES TO:** Any employer whose workers respond to hazardous substance releases — hazmat teams, fire departments, industrial emergency response teams.
- MONTHS:** All months — core framework for the entire training program.

ACCESS: <https://www.osha.gov/laws-regs/regulations/standardnumber/1910/1910.120>

29 CFR 1910.120(q)(6) — Hazmat Technician Training Competencies

- WHAT IT IS:** The subsection defining what a hazmat technician must be trained to do — performance-based competencies, not just classroom hours.
- REQUIRES:** Technicians must be trained to approach a release using specialized PPE and control methods. Covers hazard and risk assessment, hazard control, PPE use, decontamination, and emergency procedures.
- APPLIES TO:** All hazmat technicians. This is the baseline your drills are designed to maintain.
- MONTHS:** Drives objectives for January through November.

ACCESS: <https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-29/subtitle-B/chapter-XVII/part-1910/subpart-H/section-1910.120>

29 CFR 1910.120(q)(8) — Annual Refresher Training Requirement

- WHAT IT IS:** The mandatory annual refresher requirement for hazmat technicians — the legal basis for maintaining a recurring training program.
- REQUIRES:** Employees trained under (q)(6) must receive annual refresher training "of sufficient content and duration to maintain their competencies, or shall demonstrate competency in those areas at least yearly." No minimum duration is prescribed — adequacy is based on demonstrated competency.
- APPLIES TO:** All hazmat technicians and emergency response personnel.
- MONTHS:** December — annual competency demonstration (mandatory).

ACCESS: <https://www.osha.gov/emergency-preparedness/hazardous-waste-operations/standards>

29 CFR 1910.120(h) — Air Monitoring Program

- WHAT IT IS:** Requires employers to implement an air monitoring program to identify and quantify airborne contaminants and ensure proper PPE selection.
- REQUIRES:** Monitoring must be performed before and during hazmat operations. Results drive PPE selection and zone establishment decisions.
- APPLIES TO:** All hazmat operations involving potential inhalation hazards.
- MONTHS:** February (Atmospheric Monitoring) and August (Advanced Monitoring).

ACCESS: <https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-29/subtitle-B/chapter-XVII/part-1910/subpart-H/section-1910.120>

29 CFR 1910.120(k) — Decontamination

- WHAT IT IS:** Establishes decontamination procedure requirements during hazmat operations.
- REQUIRES:** A decontamination procedure must be developed and implemented before any employee enters a potentially contaminated area. All personnel and equipment leaving a contaminated area must be decontaminated.
- APPLIES TO:** All hazmat operations involving potential contamination of personnel or equipment.
- MONTHS:** March (Decontamination) and September (Mass Decon).

ACCESS: <https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-29/subtitle-B/chapter-XVII/part-1910/subpart-H/section-1910.120>

SECTION 2 — NFPA (National Fire Protection Association)

NFPA 470 (2022) — Hazardous Materials/WMD Standard for Responders

- WHAT IT IS:** Created in 2022 by consolidating NFPA 472, 473, and 1072 into one document. The single NFPA standard for hazmat responder training competencies. Uses "shall" language — mandatory where adopted by AHJ. Next edition scheduled for 2027.
- REQUIRES:** Defines competencies for Awareness, Operations, Technician, and Incident Commander levels. Chapter 11 contains Mission-Specific Competencies including radiological monitoring, atmospheric sampling, product control, decontamination, and victim rescue.
- APPLIES TO:** Hazmat responders at all levels. Technician competencies are the primary target of this training program.
- MONTHS:** All months — Chapter 11 JPRs drive drill objectives throughout the year.

ACCESS: <https://www.nfpa.org/product/nfpa-470-standard/p0470code>

NFPA 470 (2022) — Chapter 11 Mission-Specific Competencies (JPRs)

- WHAT IT IS:** The chapter defining Job Performance Requirements for specific hazmat skills beyond the core technician level — the tasks your team must be able to demonstrate.
- REQUIRES:** Competencies include: radiological monitoring, atmospheric sampling, victim rescue, product control, evidence preservation, and decontamination. Each JPR describes the condition, task, and evaluation criteria.
- APPLIES TO:** Hazmat technicians performing mission-specific functions.
- MONTHS:** Jan/Jul (Radiation) · Feb/Aug (Atmospheric) · Mar/Sep (Decon) · Apr/Oct (Leak Control) · May/Nov (Command).

ACCESS: <https://www.nfpa.org/product/nfpa-470-standard/p0470code>

NFPA 475 (2022) — Recommended Practice for Organizing, Managing, and Sustaining a Hazmat/WMD Response Program

- WHAT IT IS:** Companion to NFPA 470. Uses "should" language — a recommended practice, not a mandate. Covers how to build, manage, and sustain a hazmat program at the organizational level.
- REQUIRES:** Guidance on program structure, SOPs, resource management, training documentation, after action reviews, and inter-agency coordination. Section 9.13 addresses training records maintenance.
- APPLIES TO:** Company officers, hazmat coordinators, and program managers responsible for sustaining a hazmat response capability.
- MONTHS:** All months — program management framework. AAR guidance applies after every drill.

ACCESS: <https://www.nfpa.org/product/nfpa-475-recommended-practice/p0475code>

SECTION 3 — DOT (Department of Transportation) — Note

49 CFR 172.704 — DOT Hazmat Transportation Training Requirements

- WHAT IT IS:** The DOT training standard for hazmat employees involved in the transportation of hazardous materials in commerce — drivers, shippers, handlers, and packaging staff. Requires recurrent training every 3 years.
- REQUIRES:** General awareness, function-specific, safety, and security awareness training. Requires testing and recordkeeping. **IMPORTANT:** This governs transportation functions — it is NOT the primary training requirement for emergency responders. OSHA 1910.120(q) and NFPA 470 govern emergency response training.
- APPLIES TO:** Hazmat employees who transport, load, unload, or handle hazmat in commerce. May apply to your department if members perform transportation functions. Verify with your AHJ.

ACCESS: <https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-49/subtitle-B/chapter-I/subchapter-C/part-172/subpart-H/section-172.704>

QUICK REFERENCE — Standard-to-Month Mapping

MONTH	TOPIC	PRIMARY STANDARDS
January	Radiation Awareness	NFPA 470 Ch. 11 · OSHA 1910.120(q)(6)
February	Atmospheric Monitoring	NFPA 470 Ch. 11 · OSHA 1910.120(h)
March	Decontamination	NFPA 470 Ch. 11 · OSHA 1910.120(k) · (q)(6)
April	Leak Control	NFPA 470 Ch. 11 · OSHA 1910.120(q)(6)
May	Incident Command	NFPA 470 Ch. 11 · OSHA 1910.120(q)(3)
June	Integrated Drill	NFPA 470 Ch. 11 · OSHA 1910.120(q)(8) · NFPA 475
July	Radiation — Advanced	NFPA 470 Ch. 11 · OSHA 1910.120(q)(6)
August	Atmospheric — Advanced	NFPA 470 Ch. 11 · OSHA 1910.120(h)
September	Mass Decon	NFPA 470 Ch. 11 & 13 · OSHA 1910.120(k)
October	Leak Control — Advanced	NFPA 470 Ch. 11 · OSHA 1910.120(q)(6)
November	IC — Advanced	NFPA 470 Ch. 11 · NFPA 475 Ch. 6

MONTH	TOPIC	PRIMARY STANDARDS
December	Integrated Final (MANDATORY)	OSHA 1910.120(q)(8) · NFPA 470 Ch. 11 · NFPA 475

FOR TRAINING REFERENCE ONLY — This document summarizes regulatory requirements to assist with training program development. It is not legal advice. Always consult your Authority Having Jurisdiction (AHJ), department legal counsel, and the full text of each standard for official compliance determinations. Standards are subject to revision.